

Bylaws of the Lambda Nu Chapter of ZETA TAU ALPHA

ARTICLE I – NAME

- A. Name of this association shall be known as Lambda Nu Chapter of Zeta Tau Alpha Fraternity.

ARTICLE II – OBJECT

- A. The object of this organization shall be to promote the purpose and program of the Fraternity; to function as a constructive, vital force in the lives of its members; to cooperate with the local alumnae and to serve as a cooperative, active part of the university program.

ARTICLE III – MEMBERSHIP

- A. New Member – any regularly enrolled female student at Furman University, regardless of race, color, national origin, religion, political affiliation, handicap or age, who has met the eligibility requirements set forth in the National Constitution and Bylaws, the national policies (as set forth in the General Manual), the Lambda Nu Chapter Bylaws and Furman University is eligible for membership in the Lambda Nu chapter.
- B. Re-pledge – a woman may not be re-pledged for the third semester without the written permission of the Vice President Collegiate.
- C. Members – membership in Lambda Nu Chapter may be extended to regularly enrolled collegiate women who meet the standards of the Fraternity and the requirements set forth in the National Constitution and Bylaws, who have completed a full-time semester (12 credit hours) at a college or university, and who have a minimum 2.5 grade point average.
- D. Transfers – a transferring member of Zeta Tau Alpha may affiliate with the chapter according to the policies and procedures outlined in the General Manual.

Section I – Membership Obligations

- A. GreekLifeEdu: Completing GreekLifeEdu is a requirement for all initiated members. New Members must complete Part One of GreekLifeEdu within four weeks of Pledge Service. Part Two of GreekLifeEdu should be completed after Initiation and before the end of the semester.
- B. All members and new members must review and sign the Membership Expectations and Obligations Contract. Each fall and spring, all returning members are expected to review this policy and initial the contract, prior to any event with alcohol. All members are expected to abide by the contract. Failure to do so may result in Judicial action.

ARTICLE IV – MEETINGS

Section I – Chapter Meetings

- A. There will be a regular meeting (business, ritual, or standard) each week during the college year except during examination and vacation periods.
- B. A simple majority of the eligible voting membership shall compose a quorum (⅔) at any regular meeting.

- C. The right to vote shall be accorded to every member and new member who is: present, in good financial standing, in good scholastic standing, and has completed the Post Initiate Education (PIE).
- D. Good standing shall be defined as having earned a cumulative GPA of 2.5 for the previous semester, being up to date on her payment plan for dues, and being up to date on study hours (if applicable). Being in good standing gives members the privilege to attend all social events, vote, and be eligible to receive a Little Sister.
- E. To remain in good standing, members cannot receive more than two judicial sanctions within the same academic year. In addition, members may not miss more than two chapter meetings a semester (unexcused). Excused absences will be reviewed on a case by case basis and must be submitted to the Recording Secretary via Omega One 24 hours before the meeting.
- F. If a member becomes no longer in good standing with the chapter during the academic year, the member will be notified by the President. A judicial hearing will be held to determine how long the member will not be in good standing with the chapter and to determine if there are steps that the member can take in order to get back in good standing.
- G. Proper ritual attire will be required for all rituals and if not approved by the Ritual chair, then the member will be asked to leave and will receive a fine and loss of points, which could affect eligibility to attend social functions.

Section II – Executive Committee Meetings

- A. Executive Committee meetings shall be held once a week at a regularly scheduled time and place.
- B. All chapter business must be brought before the Executive Committee before being discussed in chapter meetings.

Section III – Special Meetings

- A. Special meetings may be held only when the General Advisor and every member and new member of the chapter has been notified.
- B. Two-thirds of the eligible voting membership shall compose a quorum at any special meeting.

Section IV – New Member Meetings

- A. New members shall attend chapter meetings.
- B. New members shall hold a regular weekly meeting under the supervision of the VPPII – New Member Coordinator and New Member Advisor until their initiation.

Section V – Program Council Meetings

- A. Program Council meetings shall be held weekly at a regularly scheduled time and place with the VPI – Coordinator of Committees presiding.
- B. Program Council members are required to attend Program Council Meetings unless a valid excuse is provided at least 24 hours prior to the meeting to the Corresponding Secretary, or the VPI deems it unnecessary for a certain Programs Council member to attend a certain meeting.
- C. Failure to attend meetings without a valid excuse or failure to fulfill the obligations of your position will have a meeting with the President and VPI who will determine the proper course of action.

- D. Special Committees – the chair and/or members of special committees shall attend Program Council meetings to discuss their events/programs, as they are being developed and planned so that the event/program can be approved using the EC/PC Process.

Article V – Power and Duties

- A. The organization shall exercise all powers usually vested in such a body, provided these do not conflict within the provisions set forth in the National Constitution and Bylaws, the manuals of the Fraternity, the national policies and directives of the Fraternity. The disciplinary powers of the Lambda Nu chapter shall be vested in the chapter Judicial Committee.

ARTICLE VI – OFFICERS

Section I –Officers

- A. Officers shall be those specified in the National Constitution and Bylaws and in *The Guide to Collegiate Chapters*.
- B. Elected officers are the Executive Council and include the following officers: President, First Vice President (Coordinator of Committees), Second Vice President (New Member Coordinator), Third Vice President (Membership Chairman), Recording Secretary, Treasurer, Historian-Reporter, Ritual Chairman, Panhellenic Delegate, Risk Management Chairman, and Academic Achievement Chairman.

Section II – Elections

- A. Elections shall follow the guidelines as stated in *The Guide for Chapter Officers*.
- B. The Nominating Committee shall be elected with one representative from the sophomore, junior, and senior classes. The General Advisor and outgoing President shall serve as ex-officio members of the committee. If the outgoing President is running for another Executive position, she will not serve on the committee.
- C. Elections shall take place in the fall semester.
- D. Those interested in running for any Executive Committee position must turn in an application and interview with the Nominating Committee. Only those who have turned in an application and interviewed with the Nominating Committee may be nominated from the floor during elections.
- E. The slate of officers shall be submitted by the Nominating Committee to the chapter one week before elections.
- F. The Nominating Committee shall make a motion to accept the slate of nominated candidates for office. If the slate does not pass by a simple majority vote of the quorum present, nominations will be taken from the floor. Elections will proceed as outlined in *The Guide for Chapter Officers*.
- G. If a vacancy in the office of President occurs, the First Vice President assumes the office. If there is no First Vice President, the Executive Council, with the approval of the Advisory Board and the Province President/Director of New Chapters, appoints a new President.
- H. If a vacancy in any other officer or chairmanship occurs, the President, with the approval of the Executive Council, the General Advisor and the Province President, appoints a replacement. If a member of the Executive Committee or Program Council makes the decision to go abroad in

their fall term, an application can be opened or an appointment can be made by the President, (VPI if position is on Programs Council), General Advisor, and Province President.

Section III – Qualifications for Office

- A. To be eligible, a member must meet the qualifications specified in the National Constitution and Bylaws, the General Manual, and *The Guide for Chapter Officers*.
 - a. President: The President must be an initiated member for at least 2 semesters and previously served in an Executive Council office or held a leadership position within the chapter.
 - b. VP1: The VP1 must have successfully completed at least one term in a Program Council position.
 - c. VP3: The VP3 must have completed at least one formal recruitment season as an initiated member before assuming the position.
- B. Executive Council members must have a 2.7 cumulative GPA to be elected into office. If an Executive Council member falls below a 2.7 cumulative GPA during their time serving on the Executive Council, this member will meet with the Academic Achievement Chair to discuss a study plan and academic goals.
- C. Special consideration may be given to those below the minimum GPA requirement if approved in advance by the Director of New Chapters/Province President.
- D. No officer may be elected or retain office while on disciplinary probation with the University and/or Zeta Tau Alpha.
- E. If any of the above qualifications are not met, the nomination must be approved by the Province President.
- F. Newly elected Executive Committee officers and Program Council officers must complete training with their respective advisors, the Province President, and the previous officers for their respective position as well as attend any other national training required for their position.

Section IV – Duties

- A. The duties of office shall be those usually assigned to such officers in Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised and such other duties as are specifically stated in *The Guide to Chapter Officers*.
- B. Failure to fulfill responsibilities of office will result in disciplinary action.

Section V – Term of Office

- A. Officers shall be installed after Officer Education and no later than one month after elections. Officers shall hold office for one year.

Section VI - Officer Education

- A. All incoming Executive Committee Officers and Program Council officers are required to attend an officer training retreat, as outlined in *The Guide for Officer Education and Leadership Development* and *The Guide for Chapter Officers*. This is to be planned and conducted by the outgoing President with assistance from other outgoing officers, as needed.

ARTICLE VII – STANDING COMMITTEES

Section I – Standing Committees

- A. Standing Committees are the appointed officers, which comprise the Program Council. These include the following directors and chairmen:
 - a. Director of Activities
 - i. Special Events Chairman (Homecoming, Greek Week, etc.)
 - ii. Apparel Chairman
 - iii. Signs Chairman
 - iv. Intramurals Chairman
 - b. Director of Philanthropy
 - i. Fundraising Chairman
 - ii. Think Pink Chairman
 - iii. Service Chairman
 - iv. External Philanthropy Chairman
 - c. Director of Member Enrichment
 - i. Sunshine Chairman
 - ii. Director of Fraternity Education (FRED)
 - iii. Music Chairman
 - iv. Inclusion Chairman
 - d. Director of Sisterhood
 - i. Alumnae Collegiate Relations Chairman
 - ii. Parent's Events Chairman
 - e. Director of Social Events
 - i. External Social Chairman
 - f. Corresponding Secretary

Section II – Special Committees

- A. Special Committees include but are not limited to: Philanthropy, Tailgate, Social, Ritual, Relay for Life, BMOC, and Homecoming.
- B. Additional Committees may be created by the chapter Executive Council and the Advisory Board as the need arises.

Section III – Qualifications for Office

- A. To be eligible for Program Council, a member must meet the qualifications specified in the National Constitution and Bylaws, the General Manual, and The Guide for Chapter Officers.
- B. Program Council members must have a 2.5 cumulative GPA, to be elected and retain office.
- C. No officer may be appointed or retain office while on disciplinary probation with the University and/or Zeta Tau Alpha.
- D. If any of the above qualifications are not met, the appointment must be approved by the Director of New Chapters/Province President.

Section IV – Appointment

- A. Members interested in holding a Program Council position must file an application stating their preferences with the First Vice President.

- B. Program Council officers and their committees shall be appointed by the President and First Vice President.
- C. Committees should be appointed within one week of election of officers to allow for participation in Officer Education.

Section V – Duties

- A. Duties of the committees shall be those usually assigned to such committees in Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised, and such other duties as are specifically stated in The Guide for Chapter Officers and as determined by the chapter Executive Council with approval of the Advisory Board and Province President.

Section VI – Term of Office

- A. Program Council Chairmen and their committees shall assume duties after appointment and shall hold office until next year's election.
- B. Failure to fulfill the responsibilities as dictated by the contract provided by VPI may result in termination of the position.

ARTICLE VIII – CHAPTER ADVISORS

Section I – Advisory Board

- A. The chapter advisory board shall consist of a minimum of four alumnae advisors: General, New Member, Membership, and Financial. If available, the positions of Program Council, Judicial, Academic Achievement, Ritual, and Social Advisors will be filled. Other advisor positions can be filled as deemed necessary.

Section II – Qualifications

- A. The nominating committee must secure the approval of the Province President before an alumna may be considered for any chapter advisor position.

Section III – Election of Advisors

- A. The election of advisors shall take place from a list of available alumnae supplied by the Executive Council of the alumnae chapter at the same time as the election of chapter officers, as specified in the General Manual. Advisors must be approved by the Province President prior to appointment.
- B. If an advisor becomes inactive or resigns, replacement is handled in the same manner.

Section IV – Duties

- A. The duties and responsibilities of advisors shall be those stated in the Guide for Advisors.

Section V – Term of Office

- A. Election of advisors shall coincide with the chapter election of officers.

- B. Advisors shall hold office for one year.

Section VI – Advisory Board Meetings

- A. Alumnae advisors will meet monthly as a board and also jointly with the Executive Council and Program Council when possible or necessary.

ARTICLE IX – FINANCES

Section I – Budgets

- A. The chapter shall operate within a budget approved by the National Secretary-Treasurer.

Section II – Income

- A. Dues, social fees, and other charges shall be as approved in the annual budget.
B. Members must abide by the financial policies as outlined in the General Manual and the *Guide to Chapter Finances*.
C. No member will be permitted to attend chapter social events if she is not in good financial standing as stated in the Guide to Chapter Finances.

Section III – Fines

- A. National fines shall be as imposed by National Officers. Local fines for unexcused absences shall be as follows:

<i>Event</i>	<i>Fine</i>
Recruitment Events: Includes but is not limited to workshops, pop-ins, etc.	\$50
Formal Recruitment: Fine will be given per party. Partial fines will be given to those who miss part of the day. This is up to the discretion of the President and VP III.	\$50
Rituals other than Initiation: Mandatory rituals will be made clear at least one month in advance. Big Sister Ceremony will be made clear two weeks in advance. Rituals will include, but are not limited to, formal chapter, Big Sister Ceremony, Formal Pledging, Rededication, Founder's Day, etc.	\$25
Initiation	\$75
Philanthropy: Mandatory events such as BMOC – specified by the Executive Council at least one month in advance.	\$50
Chapter Meetings: Members are allowed two unexcused absences. For every unexcused	\$15

chapter meeting after this they will be fined per meeting missed.	
Zeta Day: If members sign up to attend and do not go or members fail to sign up without submitting a valid excuse.	\$80
Composites: If a member fails to attend the chapters scheduled composite time with the discretion of the Historian.	\$25

- B. Additional fineable events will be announced as soon as they are known. These events could include events such as workshops hosted by Panhellenic. The Executive Council will decide the appropriate amount to fine depending on the event. These fines could include mandatory events, such as Furman SPM training, composite photos, Panhellenic events, Homecoming activities, Greek Week events, etc.
- C. Missed events will be billed immediately following the event. National Fraternity policies will be followed with regard to collecting these fees. Any member who is more than 10 days delinquent in her payment will lose both social and voting privileges until she has met her financial obligations.
- D. Chapter meeting excuses must be submitted no later than 24 hours before the date of the meeting. All excuses for other mandatory events must be submitted one week in advance of the event. If an excuse is received after this time frame it will be considered an unexcused absence and the member will be subject to a fine. See Article X Section II for a list of acceptable excuses.
- E. In the case of illness or emergency, please notify the Recording Secretary by phone. Members who do not notify the Recording Secretary prior to the activity will be fined.

Section IV – Reduced Fees

- A. All members who student teach, co-op, or intern a minimum of 60 miles off campus or approximately 1 hour away while participating in a college sponsored program are to be charged per capita, insurance, scholarship, and House Reserve Fund only, if approved by the National Secretary-Treasurer. Permission must be received in writing the semester before fees can be lowered.

ARTICLE X – ATTENDANCE AND PARTICIPATION

Section I – Points System

- A. A points system shall be maintained to monitor and ensure active participation in chapter activities. The current points system is explained in Article XI and outlined in Appendix A.

Section II – Acceptable Excuses for Mandatory Events

- A. Acceptable excuses for mandatory events include the following:
 - a. Sickness with doctor documentation
 - b. Death or funeral
 - c. Class or exam
 - d. Family emergency

- e. Group project with proof from professor
- f. Career fairs
- g. Work or work interview
- h. Scheduled vacation with proof of ticket purchase before the semester calendar was presented
- i. Athletic team game, practice, or other required event (such as team dinner) specified as mandatory by the coach.
- j. Religious activities, holidays, or events
- k. Other required events for class or other required events for campus organizations in which you are an official representative of Furman
- B. Excuses must be sent to the Recording Secretary one week in advance of the scheduled activity through Omega One.
 - a. In the case of illness or emergency, please notify the Recording Secretary by phone call. Members who do not notify the Recording Secretary prior to the activity will not receive points. Members should be ready to submit proof of their excuse to the Recording Secretary. Failure to submit proof of an excuse will result in the event being counted as unexcused and relevant fines will be applied.

Section III – Required Involvement

- A. Every member must be involved in an outside campus activity. In the event that a member is not involved, that member will have a meeting with the Director of Activities.
- B. All members must participate in a minimum of 1 service event each semester. Service requirements must be an outside event approved by the Service Chairman.

ARTICLE XI – POINT POLICY

- A. Points will be updated on a weekly basis and can be found on Omega One.
- B. Points will accumulate for a semester and will renew at the beginning of each semester.
- C. Should the University acquire housing, totals will be archived from the previous fall semester and added to the current winter semester to create the ranking of members for live-in selections.

Section I – Purpose

- A. The purpose of the points system is to encourage attendance at all chapter activities and participation in other campus organizations by allowing the individual members to choose those meetings and functions that best fit into her schedule. Every member must complete a certain number of events per category, as indicated by a specific color out of a possible maximum number of events per color coordinated category to remain in good member standing. Failure to meet point requirements specified at the beginning of each semester by the indicated deadlines will result in the loss of social privileges. Failure to obtain all required points by the end of the semester will result in the member appearing before the Judicial Committee.
- B. This design is heavily reliant on executive council (especially the efforts of the President, Vice President I, and Recording Secretary) to produce a series of monthly calendars containing all semester events broken down by category by the beginning of each semester. The corresponding colors and categories are as follows:

- a. Chapter Meetings
- b. Philanthropy Events
- c. Rituals
- d. Sisterhood Events
- e. External Events

Section II – Points System Process

- A. The points calendar, which lists all scheduled activities, can be accessed on Omega One and will be reiterated at chapter meetings each week by the Recording Secretary. In order to include an activity on the point's calendar, the chapter must be notified at least two weeks prior to the event. The chapter must be notified of rituals and mandatory events at least a month in advance or as soon as the Executive Council is notified of these events.
- B. Extra points for non-required events may be given to encourage member participation.
- C. Points will be posted on Omega One by the Recording Secretary.

ARTICLE XII – ACADEMIC ACHIEVEMENT

Section I – Member Study Hours

- A. Any member making below a 2.5 for the previous semester will meet with the Academic Achievement Chairman at the beginning of the semester to create a study plan for the upcoming semester.
- B. Any member making below a 2.5 for the previous semester will submit midterm grades to the Academic Achievement Chairman.
- C. Study hours are to be completed by both Initiated Members and New Members. Study hours are put in place in order for chapter members to exceed the sorority's expectations not just meet the chapter's requirements. Study hours will be implemented by the Academic Achievement Chairman using the following guidelines based on each member's prior semester GPA:

3.0+ 0 hours

2.75-2.99 3 hours

2.5-2.74 4 hours

2.30-2.49 5 hours

2.29-2.00 6 hours

2.00 or below 7 hours

Section II – Study Hours Procedures

- A. Procedures for study hours are outlined as follows:
 - a. Members must complete their required number of study hours every week. Excess hours do not roll over.
 - b. Members must complete half of their assigned study hours in the ZTA Study Room (outlined in point B below).
 - c. Members cannot leave their phones in the library or another study location in order to log their hours.

- d. Special permission to study away from the library for studio hours, editing lab hours, etc. may be approved by AACH only. This must be done prior to the event. Members cannot study in a location that does not align with a member's major.
 - e. A member who fails to complete or violate points A, B, C, or D will be placed on temporary social probation and will be referred to the Judicial Committee by the AACH.
- B. Chapter members must complete half of their assigned study hours in the ZTA Study Room every week. The ZTA Study Room will be a specific location on campus that will be available for a wide range of hours each week. Therefore, each chapter member who is required to complete hours in the ZTA Study Room has a wide range of options for when they can complete these hours.
 - a. The ZTA Study Room will be completely silent and will be monitored by a member of the Executive Committee to help maintain a quiet and productive study environment. All chapter members are allowed to study in the ZTA Study Room; however, only those who have a GPA of a 2.99 or below are required to complete study hours in the ZTA Study Room each week.

ARTICLE XIII – ONLINE WEBSITE REGULATION

Section I – Social Media

- A. Absolutely NO Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, SnapChat or any social media or photos, videos, or texts and captions may depict:
 - a. Alcohol consumption or possession if under the age of 21.
 - i. Exception: If the individual is in another country where alcohol consumption is legal, the post must clearly indicate where the photo was taken.
 - ii. Members over the age of 21 or members in aforementioned exception, should not post distasteful, belligerent photos of alcohol consumption.
 - b. Illicit drug consumption or possession.
 - c. Abusing, harassing, or bullying any other individual.
 - d. Use of ZTA letters or symbols in the presences of alcohol.
 - e. Material that is obscene, pornographic, or otherwise offensive.
- B. Profiles of a Zeta are NOT to include:
 - a. Discussion of alcohol consumption or possession.
 - b. Discussion of drug consumption or possession.
 - c. Discussion with obscene, pornographic, or otherwise offensive content.
- C. Members must allow all officers to follow all of their social media accounts including, but not limited to, Facebook, Instagram, Snapchat, any “finstas”... etc. Additionally, all members with an Instagram must allow the @furmanzta follow their accounts.
 - a. Note: Zeta Tau Alpha does not condone the use of “finsta” accounts.

Section II – Strike System

- A. There will be a three-strike system for all posts, photos, captions, and texts that violate the above criteria.
 - a. True Warning – If post is removed or changed within 24 hours (4 hours if on Snapchat or Instagram story). If post is not removed or changed, this would result in Strike One.
 - b. Strike One
 - c. Strike Two
 - d. Strike Three – Judicial Charges Filed

- e. All subsequent strikes will result in Judicial Charges
- D. Members will be notified of the need to remove their social media post by strawberry emoji if the post needs to be removed or the “monocle man” emoji if the caption needs to be changed because it violates one or more of the requirements stated above. For Snapchat stories, the member will be notified directly by an officer if their story needs to be taken down.

ARTICLE XIV – SOCIALS

- A. All members must conduct themselves in a manner consistent with all standards, regulations, and values of Zeta Tau Alpha. If any ZTA member is found not upholding these morals at any ZTA function/event, the following will result:
 - a. If a member is seen conducting herself in a manner not becoming of ZTA policies, the Risk and Reduction Chair and President will arrange for her and her date to leave the social function, and she will be subject to judicial charges.
 - b. ZTA members are fully responsible for their guest’s actions and behaviors at social functions. In the event that a ZTA member’s guest behaves inappropriately, that ZTA member and her guest will be asked to leave. The ZTA member could be subject to judicial proceedings to assess the situation. Depending on the behavior, guests may not be allowed back to ZTA functions.
- B. The President, Risk Chair, Social Chair, and one other member of the Executive Council must serve as a Sober Sister at every social.

ARTICLE XV – BIG SISTER ELIGIBILITY AND PAIRINGS

- A. In order for a chapter member to be eligible to be a Big Sister, she must be in good standing with the chapter, as mentioned in Article IX, Section I, D. as well as attend the Big Sister Training led by the VP II. Matching of Big Sisters and Little Sisters will proceed as follows:
 - a. Eligible Sisters will be ranked in order of GPA from highest to lowest. If there are less Little Sisters than potential Big Sisters, the potential Big Sisters with the lowest GPAs will not receive a Little Sister.
 - b. If there are more Little Sisters than potential Big Sisters, a Big Sister can receive more than one Little Sister. The VP II will take matching preferences and her own discretion into consideration on who is paired with more than one Little Sister.
 - c. Potential Big Sisters and Little Sisters will rank their top 3 choices for matching and explain why she would like each of her choices as a Big Sister or Little Sister. The VP II and President will pair 1-to-1 matches first. The VP II and President will then use the preference listings and additional information for all subsequent matching.

ARTICLE XVI – PROCEDURES

- A. All matters of procedure not covered by these Bylaws shall be governed by Robert’s Rules of Order, Newly Revised.

ARTICLE AMENDMENTS

- A. These Bylaws may be amended by a 2/3 vote of the membership provided the proposed amendments were presented at the previous meeting and previously approved by the Province President/Director of New Chapters. Bylaws should be revised every 2 years.

APPENDIX A: Points - Refer to attached Points document.

Skyler Fox, Recording Secretary 2020

Jamie Ward, President 2020

Coryn Owens, Province President, VI Beta 2020